

It's Not Your Fault

A Practical Guide for Families Caring for an Aging Parent

Rob Brizzi, CDP · Certified Dementia Practitioner | Cardinal Promise Press

The map no one hands you when a parent starts to decline — a calm, color-coded field guide that takes a family from the first unsettling change through hospice and the hours after, one page at a time.

THE BOOK

A 228-page, full-color, 8.5×11 workbook — 29 chapters across five parts, color-coded by urgency (**red** = **act today**, **purple** = **watch closely**, **blue** = **plan ahead**). It is built to be opened in a crisis, not read cover to cover: a "Start Here: The First 24–72 Hours" section, five "Find Your Situation" pathways, a decision tree, a 30-second summary box opening every chapter, worksheets and family-to-clinician scripts throughout, and a "Rob's Note" closing each chapter with the human truth.

WHAT IT COVERS

The first signals (falls, memory loss, caregiver burnout, the family meeting) · every care setting (home health, assisted living, memory care, skilled nursing, palliative care, hospice) · the money (Medicare, Medicaid, private pay, long-term care insurance, VA) · the documents (powers of attorney, advance directives, DNR/MOST/POLST) · and the last days and after death.

WHO IT'S FOR & WHY IT'S DIFFERENT

The tens of millions of U.S. family caregivers — adult children and spouses suddenly responsible for a declining parent, with no training and no map. Most guides are either clinical reference tomes or gentle grief books; this is both practical *and* human — logistics plus grace. Its thesis is its title: caregivers drown in guilt they never earned, so it gives them permission *and* a plan.

THE AUTHOR

Rob Brizzi is a Certified Dementia Practitioner with a career across home health, hospice, and senior living. He wrote it after his father Lou's death — the toolkit he wishes every family had been handed. He is the founder of The Cardinal's Promise and author of the forthcoming memoir of the same name.

COMPARABLE TITLES

The 36-Hour Day · *Being Mortal* · *How to Care for Aging Parents* — but shorter, action-first, and color-coded for crisis use.

Status: Manuscript complete and page-numbered · cover designed (cream, cardinal) · real ISBN assigned (979-8-9966446-0-5, Cardinal Promise Press) · ready for printed proofs.

Series & editions: Audiobook and ebook planned; a laminated crisis trifold and state-specific companion guides in the *Cardinal's Promise* series; the memoir joins it later.